Handova

An initiative of **Ethical Bridge**

TRUST & SAFETY · CODE

Code of Conduct

The standards everyone on Handova agrees to: respect for local leadership, honesty, care and safety.

Version 1.1 | Approved 9 November 2026
Handova, an initiative of Ethical Bridge LLC

Skills handed over.
Capability that stays.

DOCUMENT CONTROL

About this document

DOCUMENT	Handova Code of Conduct
TYPE	Code
OWNER	Julieta Castiñeira de Dios
APPROVED BY	Julieta Castiñeira de Dios, founder, for Ethical Bridge LLC
VERSION	1.1 (version 1.0 approved on 20 October 2026)
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CHANGES IN THIS VERSION	Students included throughout; new extra standards for students (take on only work you can deliver, academic credit, coursework); new section 8, ready to work remotely, for everyone.
NEXT REVIEW	October 2027, or sooner when Handova has a team, after a serious incident or when the law changes
APPLIES TO	Professionals and students, organisations and their staff, and the Handova team
OPERATOR	Handova is an initiative of Ethical Bridge LLC, registered in Wyoming, USA
CONTACT	safeguarding@handova.org · hello@handova.org
LANGUAGE	English. Read it online at handova.org/#policies

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PROPORTIONATE TO OUR SIZE

Handova is in its early stage. Today one person, the founder, runs both Handova and Ethical Bridge. This is our **first version**: it sets out what we do now and who does it. We will expand it as Handova grows and builds a team with dedicated safeguarding and compliance roles. Until then:

- **Julieta Castiñeira de Dios, the founder, is the safeguarding lead.** She receives reports, decides on protective action and keeps the records described here.
- **An independent contact** handles any concern about the founder, or that the founder is involved in, and covers urgent cases when the founder can't be reached for more than 48 hours. This is a trusted person outside Handova and Ethical Bridge: **to be confirmed soon**. They don't run Handova or investigate alone: they receive the concern, make sure it is handled fairly and get outside advice when needed.
- **We review this code** at least once a year, as soon as Handova has a team, and after any serious incident.

AT A GLANCE

- The organisation decides. Professionals and students support local leadership; they never take it over.
- Hand the work over so it keeps working without you.
- Be truthful about who you are, what you can do, the hours you worked and what the work achieved. Endorsements are never traded, inflated or pressured.
- Contributions are remote only. Talk on Handova Messages until a contribution agreement is signed.
- Safeguarding comes first. We follow the IASC six core principles on sexual exploitation and abuse. Report any concern within 24 hours.
- Share the minimum, keep it confidential, and never put personal or confidential information into AI tools.
- No payment, gifts, recruitment, sales or job trials through Handova. Declare any conflict of interest.
- Offer only the time you really have, and take on only work you can deliver well. Anyone can pause or stop.
- Contributions happen online, so everyone needs a computer, a reliable internet connection and the skills to work remotely.
- Students follow every rule in this code, plus the extra standards for students.

WHO THIS APPLIES TO

This code applies to everyone who takes part in Handova:

- **Professionals and students**: everyone with a professional profile, from the moment they sign up. In this code, “professionals” includes students, and the extra standards for students apply to them as well.
- **Organisations**: the person who signs for the organisation, everyone who uses its account, its safeguarding focal points, and any staff or volunteers who work with a professional or student on a contribution. The signatory makes sure they know this code.

- **The Handova team**: today, Julieta Castiñeira de Dios, the founder and only administrator, and in future anyone who acts for Handova.

It applies on the platform, in any other channel used for a contribution, and online whenever your conduct could affect Handova or the people it works with. It sits alongside the agreements you sign and does not replace them. If an organisation's own code or safeguarding policy is stricter, **the stricter rule applies**.

Law. Ethical Bridge LLC is registered in Wyoming, USA, and is subject to US federal and Wyoming law. People take part from many countries, so we also follow the law that applies where they are, including the EU and UK GDPR for personal data. Where rules differ, we follow the one that gives people more protection.

If in doubt, ask: does this protect everyone's dignity, safety and privacy? Could it look as if money, gifts or favours are influencing a decision or an endorsement? If it gives you pause, choose the more cautious option and ask Handova at hello@handova.org.

Our commitments

1. Respect local leadership: the organisation decides

- Organisations define their own needs, priorities and ways of working. Professionals give advice; the organisation makes the decisions.
- Professionals work with the organisation's team, not around it. They do not contact its funders, partners or the people it serves unless the organisation asks.
- Professionals do not speak, publish, sign, raise funds or make commitments for the organisation unless it asks in writing.
- No one uses a contribution to promote religious, political or commercial views.
- Handova is a platform that reviews and connects. It is not a funder, regulator or employer, and it does not supervise the work or guarantee outcomes.

2. Hand over, don't create dependency

- Professionals deliver the output in a form the team can use, change and maintain without them, with the explanation or short training agreed.
- No lock-in: no tools only they can run, no accounts in their own name, no access kept after handover.
- Within 7 days of the contribution ending, professionals return or delete the organisation's information and give back all access.

3. Honesty about skills, hours and outcomes

Accurate profiles and needs

- Professionals and students join as themselves, with one account. Name, photo, experience and qualifications are true and match their LinkedIn profile. Students and career changers describe their level honestly.
- Professionals verify their own identity with Didit. Never share an account or let anyone else work under your name.
- Organisations publish only real needs: one clear output, 1 to 16 hours, work they will use. A need never hides extra scope or replaces a paid role or ongoing staff duties.

- Everyone keeps their information up to date and tells Handova promptly about important changes, including anything covered by the conduct declaration.

Truthful hours

- Professionals log only hours they actually worked on the agreed output, and never more than 12 hours in a day.
- Organisations review logged hours honestly and on time, within 14 days.
- Inventing or inflating hours, endorsements or evidence is fraud and leads to removal.

Endorsements and impact CV integrity

The impact CV is trusted because the organisation, not the professional, provides the evidence. To protect it:

- The organisation writes the endorsement in its own words, about work it saw, including when the work was only partly delivered. Professionals never draft their own.
- No reciprocal endorsements: never in exchange for a LinkedIn recommendation, extra free hours, a donation or any other favour.
- No pressure. A professional who thinks an endorsement is wrong uses "Ask for a correction" once, then accepts the organisation's decision or reports a concern.
- An endorsement never comes from the professional's family member, partner or close friend.
- Professionals describe their work accurately everywhere: real hours, real output, and outcomes only as the organisation described them.
- Organisations answer the six-month check-in honestly, even when the work is no longer in use.

4. Safeguarding first

Remote only, and no contact with people at risk

- Every Handova contribution is remote. Needs never involve direct contact with children or adults at risk, or access to their personal information, case files or identity documents.
- If a need turns out to involve either, stop and report it.
- In-person meetings are not part of Handova, and hours spent in person are not logged on Handova.
- Handova never arranges visits to, or promotes, orphanages or residential care institutions as volunteering or tourism destinations.

Stay on Handova Messages

- Before a contribution agreement is signed, all contact happens on Handova Messages. Do not ask for or share personal phone numbers, emails or social media before then.
- After signing, personal contact details are shared only if both sides want to. Changes to the output, hours or deadline are still agreed in Messages, so there is a clear record. Handova reads a conversation only once it is reported.

Protection from sexual exploitation and abuse

Handova follows the six core principles of the Inter-Agency Standing Committee (IASC):

1. Sexual exploitation and abuse are gross misconduct and grounds for immediate removal from Handova.
2. No sexual activity with anyone under 18, whatever the local age of consent. Mistaken belief about someone's age is no defence.

3. Never exchange money, work, help, services, visibility, endorsements or any other advantage for sex or sexual favours, or for any other humiliating, degrading or exploitative behaviour.
4. Sexual relationships with the people an organisation serves are strongly discouraged, because of the unequal power involved. Any existing relationship must be declared to Handova.
5. Anyone with a concern or suspicion about sexual exploitation or abuse by anyone connected to Handova must report it.
6. Everyone is responsible for creating and keeping an environment that prevents sexual exploitation and abuse.

Never create, view, store or share sexual or abusive material, including child sexual abuse material, on any device.

Reporting concerns

- If you see, suspect or are told about harm, abuse, exploitation, harassment or fraud, report it within 24 hours. You do not need proof.
- Professionals report to the organisation's safeguarding focal point and to Handova. If the concern involves the organisation or its focal point, report only to Handova.
- Report with **Report a concern** on any profile, need, conversation or contribution, or email safeguarding@handova.org. If the concern is about the founder, write to the independent contact (**to be confirmed soon**). If someone is in immediate danger, contact local emergency services first.
- Reports made on the platform get an automatic acknowledgement with a reference. Emailed reports are acknowledged within 2 working days, the same day if someone may be at risk.
- Do not investigate yourself. Cooperate with any review and keep it confidential.
- No one is penalised for raising a genuine concern, even if it proves unfounded. Retaliation is itself a breach of this code.

5. Confidentiality and data care

Confidential information and personal data

- Share confidential information only after signing, only what the work needs, anonymised wherever possible, through a secure channel the organisation chooses.
- Never share passwords, payment-card details, PINs or access codes through Handova. Use individual, least-access accounts, removed when the work ends.
- The organisation remains responsible for personal data it shares. Professionals use it only on its instructions, and keep its information confidential during and after the contribution.
- Report any data breach to the other party and to Handova within 24 hours.

AI tools in the work

- Be open about AI. Tell the organisation if AI tools produced a substantial part of a deliverable, and list any AI-generated material in it, as the contribution agreement requires.
- Check everything AI produces for accuracy, bias and licence terms. The professional stays responsible for the work.
- Never put personal, confidential, report, identity or safeguarding information into AI tools. Use AI tools with any other information from the organisation only with its written permission.
- Never create synthetic images, audio or video of real people.

- AI can help draft or translate, but a person writes each endorsement and makes every review and report decision.

Intellectual property

- As the agreements set out, the organisation owns the work handed over. Professionals keep what they created before or outside the contribution and license the organisation to use anything of it included in the work.
- Hand over only work you have the right to share, and declare any third-party, open-source or AI-generated material and its licence.

6. Fairness and no discrimination

Respect and inclusion

- Treat everyone with dignity and respect. No harassment, bullying, intimidation or abuse, on the platform or anywhere else.
- Do not discriminate on grounds including age, disability, gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, marital or family status, pregnancy, race, colour, ethnicity, caste, nationality, national or social origin, language, religion or belief, political opinion, health or HIV status, or socio-economic status.
- Organisations choose professionals on the skills the need requires. A working language or time zone is fine when the work genuinely needs it.
- Make reasonable adjustments so people can take part fully.

Conflicts of interest

Declare any actual, possible or perceived conflict to Handova and the organisation before applying or inviting, or as soon as it arises. Examples:

- A professional who works for, or advises, a current or likely funder of the organisation.
- A close family, partner or personal tie between a professional and the organisation's leaders or staff.
- A financial or professional link with the organisation's suppliers or competitors.

A conflict is allowed only with a written declaration and Handova's agreement on how it is managed. A professional can never be endorsed by an organisation they lead, work for or have a close family link to.

Never allowed

- Using Handova to recruit for paid work, sell services, find clients, advertise, or raise funds from professionals.
- Offering or accepting unpaid job trials, or any work presented as a step towards a paid role.
- Asking for, offering or accepting payment for work arranged through Handova. Any expenses need separate written terms agreed before anything is spent.
- A professional receiving, holding or moving an organisation's money.
- Bribes, facilitation payments or any improper advantage.

If a paid opportunity at the organisation arises independently, the professional applies through the organisation's normal open process, not through Handova.

Gifts and hospitality

- Do not ask for, offer or accept gifts, hospitality, payments or favours connected to a Handova contribution.

- A thank-you message, the endorsement and the impact CV record are how Handova says thank you.

7. Wellbeing and realistic commitments

- Professionals and students offer only the monthly hours they can really give (at least 4), and apply only for needs they have the knowledge, skills and capacity to deliver.
- No one is expected to work beyond the agreed hours, at unreasonable times, or to continue if they feel unsafe or uncomfortable. Organisations never pressure a professional to do more, and reply within a reasonable time, usually a week.
- Anyone can end a contribution from its page, giving a short reason. End it early and through Handova rather than disappearing.
- Professionals make sure their employer allows the contribution, and never use an employer's confidential information, time or resources without permission. Students check their university's rules if they want the contribution to count towards their studies.

8. Ready to work remotely

Every contribution happens online, so everyone who takes part needs:

- their own computer, or reliable access to one, for the whole contribution;
- an internet connection good enough for video calls and shared documents;
- to be comfortable with email, video calls, shared documents and the online tools the organisation uses, and willing to learn a new one if the work needs it;
- a secure set-up: a screen lock, up-to-date software, their own accounts, and a private place for calls about confidential work.

If a connection or equipment problem puts a deadline at risk, tell the other side in Messages as soon as possible and agree what to do.

Talking about the work publicly

- Professionals and students may describe their contribution on their impact CV, CV and professional profiles in general terms (organisation, output, hours), without anything confidential.
- Ask the organisation first before posting more: deliverables, screenshots, tags, quotes or writing about its work.
- Never share the identity, images, stories or personal details of the people an organisation serves. Never use images of children.
- Organisations do not name or show a professional or student publicly without their agreement.
- Keep personal views separate from Handova. Only Julieta Castiñeira de Dios, the founder, or someone she authorises, speaks for Handova.

Extra standards for students

Students take part with a professional profile and follow every rule in this code. Being a student never lowers the standards on safeguarding, data or honesty. These extra standards help students take on work they can deliver well.

- **Take on only what you can deliver.** Apply only for needs you have the knowledge, skills, time and capacity to complete to a good standard. If you are unsure whether a need suits your level, ask the organisation in Messages before you apply.
- **Be clear about your level.** Say on your profile and in each application that you are a student, what you are studying and what experience you have. Never present coursework, group work or someone else's work as your own professional experience.
- **Speak up early.** If the work turns out to be beyond you, or you fall behind, tell the organisation straight away. Agree a smaller output, ask for guidance, or end the contribution through Handova. Don't hand over work you know is not good enough, and don't disappear.
- **Plan around your studies.** Offer only the hours you can give during term time and exams, and agree deadlines that fit your academic calendar.
- **Academic credit stays with your university.** If you want the contribution to count towards your studies, check your university's rules before you start. Your university supervises, assesses and decides on credit. The organisation and Handova can confirm your hours and what you handed over, but they do not grade you.
- **Keep the organisation's information out of your coursework.** Use the organisation's name, information or deliverables in an assignment, presentation or thesis only with its written permission, and never include anything confidential or personal.
- **Organisations working with students** describe the need clearly, say whether it suits a student, give the brief and feedback the work needs, and never treat a student as unpaid staff or as a trial for a paid role.

Extra standards for the Handova team

Today Julieta Castiñeira de Dios is the only member of the team and the only administrator. These standards apply to her now and to anyone who joins.

- Review organisations, profiles and needs against the published criteria only. Money, gifts or relationships never influence a review or visibility.
- Declare any link with an organisation or professional and step back from decisions about them; the independent contact (**to be confirmed soon**) reviews those cases.
- Use admin access only for its purpose. Read a conversation only once it is reported. Use admin actions proportionately and record the reason in the case notes.
- Keep reports confidential, shared only with those who need to know.
- Never enter personal, confidential, report, identity or safeguarding information into AI tools.
- Admins do not take part in needs as professionals.

If the code is breached

Report breaches as described in section 4. Handova acts in proportion to the risk. Depending on the case, Handova may:

- give a reminder or warning;
- pause engagements, freeze a conversation, take down a need or close a contribution;
- remove impact CV entries based on false hours or endorsements;
- suspend or close a profile or organisation account, and tell the people involved;

- report to the relevant authorities where the law requires it, or where someone is in immediate danger, and share information with the Ethical Bridge directory or regulators where the law or someone's safety requires it.

For serious concerns, including sexual exploitation or abuse, Handova may act straight away. For serious or complex cases, Handova may bring in an external adviser or investigator. Where the law allows, we may share confirmed findings of sexual exploitation, abuse or harassment with organisations that ask, following the principles of the Misconduct Disclosure Scheme. For the Handova team, a breach may also end their role.

Where Handova restricts or removes an account or content, we tell the person why and how to ask for a review. You can ask for a review of a suspension or removal within 30 days by writing to hello@handova.org. The independent contact (**to be confirmed soon**), who was not involved in the original decision, reviews it. We will expand this procedure as Handova grows.

Related documents

- Handova professional agreement, organisation agreement and contribution agreement
- Terms of use, privacy notice and "Working responsibly" on handova.org
- The Handova policy set: Safeguarding Policy and Procedure; Anti-Harassment, Intimidation and Bullying Policy and Procedure; Code of Conduct; Data Protection Policy; Fraud, Bribery and Corruption Policy and Procedure; Whistleblowing Policy and Procedure; Independent Contact Role Note

Acknowledgement

Shown at sign-up as one statement with a tick box. For organisations, the signatory confirms it on the organisation's behalf. Handova team members confirm it when they join.

> I have read the Handova Code of Conduct. I will follow it whenever I take part in Handova, together with the agreements I sign. Where my organisation's rules are stricter, I will follow the stricter rule. I will report concerns within 24 hours. I understand that breaking this code can lead to removal from Handova and, where required, referral to the authorities. *(Organisations add: I will make sure everyone who works with professionals and students for us, including our safeguarding focal points, knows this code.)*